A-A-51219A
30 May 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051219(DM)
15 November 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STERILIZATION TEST AMPULES, BACTERIAL SPORE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers sterilization test ampules used for monitoring steam and ethylene oxide sterilization.

Salient characteristics:

The ampules shall contain biological/chemical indicators suitable for indicating the efficacy of steam and ethylene oxide sterilization. The ampules shall be suitable for use with an Incubator, Sterilization Indicator, Steam, National Stock Number 6640-01-169-0270 and an appropriate incubator which is preset for 37°C for use with ethylene oxide exposed indicators. The item shall consist of a friction-fit cap on a clear plastic ampule containing the following:

a) A crushable vial containing a growth medium and a PH indicator;

b) A filter paper disc impregnated with viable Bacillus Stearothermophilus and Bacillus Subtilis, dry bacterial spores adjusted to give pre-determined resistance; and

c) External sterilization indicators that change color during the sterilization process itself (These markings differentiate sterilized from unsterilized ampules and also differentiate between exposure to steam or EtO). The indicator shall respond to steam sterilization at a minimum temperature of 250°F (121°C). The cap shall be capable of being pressed on the ampule. When the cap is unpressed, it shall allow the sterilizing agents to enter the ampule for sterilization.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Pressing the cap down shall cause the ampule to be sealed from its surroundings and crush the medium vial, allowing the medium and spores to mix. The vial shall be clear and colorless. The indicators shall be capable of showing bacterial growth by changing the ampule's content color from red to bright yellow within a 48 hour time frame. The growth medium shall sustain a 7 day incubation period without a color reversal when properly sealed.

When teamed with the aforesaid incubator, the system shall meet the U.S.P. XIX and U.S.P XX Standards. The overall height of the indicator, with the cap not pressed, shall be approximately 6.0 centimeters. The labeling of the indicator shall meet the requirements of the Food, and Drug Administration and the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. The overall height of the indicator with the cap pressed shall be approximately 5.4 centimeters. The outside diameter of the ampule, below the cap, shall be approximately 1.3 centimeters. The labels of the immediate container and the unit package of supply shall be those usually furnished by the supplier as commercial practice. Additions to these labels shall be limited to the application of the NSN to the unit package, and the expiration date to the immediate container (strip labeling is acceptable). When the unit package is the shipping container, additional labeling may be applied.

Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The sterilization ampules shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred indicators along with directions for use, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contact or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. the unit of product for test purposes shall be one test ampule.

Shelf life. Product delivered to Depot shall have at least 12 months time remaining on expiration date.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-01-149-5872

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

YQP H1008

Project No. 6530-1895

Location: CID/STERIL-TEST-AMP.H1B-3

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